

Architecture of Fleet Street

North Side - from Ludgate Circus to Bolt Court

No. 148

THE HERITAGE of FLEET STREET

April 2026

(claxity.com) indicates a full description on www.claxity.com Further details and images of Listed buildings can be accessed on www.historicengland.org.uk/sitesearch and entering the address; if accessing many listed buildings, use the map search

LUDGATE CIRCUS TO SHOE LANE

Thomas Cook (No.107–111, currently Ludgate House)

Built from 1872 and extended in 1906, it wraps ornate Classicism from Ludgate Circus onto Fleet Street. Sculptures about travel around the doorcases is of special interest. Original design by Horace Gundy. (claxity.com)

Daily Express Building (No. 120–129)

The former newspaper premises stretch across an entire block, from Poppins Lane to Shoe Lane and St Bride Street. At the corner with Shoe Lane, is a 1930 curtain-walled Streamline Moderne icon clad in black airtrolite and glass and cantilevered over the side return. The exterior and advanced construction are largely the work of Owen Williams. The entrance hall is an Art Deco design by Robert Atkinson. Grade II* listed.

JUNCTION WITH SHOE LANE

No. 130

A rather odd mix of Northern Renaissance and Neogothic details with large modernist upper-storey windows. 1907 by RM Roe.

No. 131

This somewhat Postmodern entrance shows how No.130 and Mersey House were grouped into a single edifice (for Goldman Sachs) in 1988 by Kohn Pederson Fox.

Mersey House (No. 132–134)

Formerly the London offices of the Liverpool Post and Liverpool Echo, it is a late (1904) example of Arts & Crafts. Large granite entrance archway followed by a bold bow front, flanked by cyclopean columns. Grade II listed.

Daily Telegraph Building (No. 135–141)

Replacing an earlier 1881 building for the same newspaper, this 1928 design by T. Tait with Elcock & Sutcliffe is a bold expression of Art Deco eclecticism, including Classicising, Egyptian Revival and geometric details. Note the tripartite façade, vertically and horizontally. The basement and ground storey, with allegorical carving above the door and metal-framed display windows, are followed by an almost full-width balcony and giant fluted columns. Geometric mouldings fade towards the tall fenestration of the side bays. The attic storeys are set back from the side wings, creating a stepped composition. Grade II listed.

The Kings & Keys (No. 142)

A former pub with a narrow Neo-Jacobean façade inscribed '1884' by Hooker & Hemming, displaying complex window articulation, carved spandrels and window aprons beneath a shaped gable.

Queen of Scots House (No. 143–144)

Gothic Revival of 1905 by R. M. Roe, with delicate tracery at the window lintels and aprons, plus bargeboard flashing beneath the twin gables. A statue of Mary Queen of Scots between the bays was specified by the developer. Grade II listed.

Ye Olde Cheshire Cheese (No. 145)

The Neo-Georgian shopfront on Fleet Street dates from 1991 (Waterhouse & Ripley), but the building fabric is C17 with C18 and C19 additions. Historical interiors are well preserved and the entrance from Wine Office Court is C18. Grade II listed.

ENTRANCE TO WINE OFFICE COURT

No. 146

This Grade II listed building, partly overhanging Wine Office Court, is largely C17 despite later modifications. It is a basic brick box construction.

No. 147

C20 rebuild on the original narrow plot, with undistinguished band windows slightly enlivened by basketweave brick bond between floors.

No. 148

Spanning the entrance to Hind Court, this Victorian white stucco refacing has limited appeal beyond the carved spandrels in the fifth-storey window arches.

No. 149

Late C19, simplified Jacobean style with a striped arch on the second storey and a carved pulvinated frieze above the fourth. Terminates with a slightly abstracted Dutch gable.

Nos. 150–151

Despite being unified by common cornices, brick bands and ribbon windows, each subplot is articulated differently: No. 150 is flanked by suspended piers, while No. 151 has two bas-relief colonnettes on the second storey. Above the cornice, two oculi frame a cramped dormer arrangement.